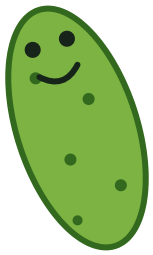
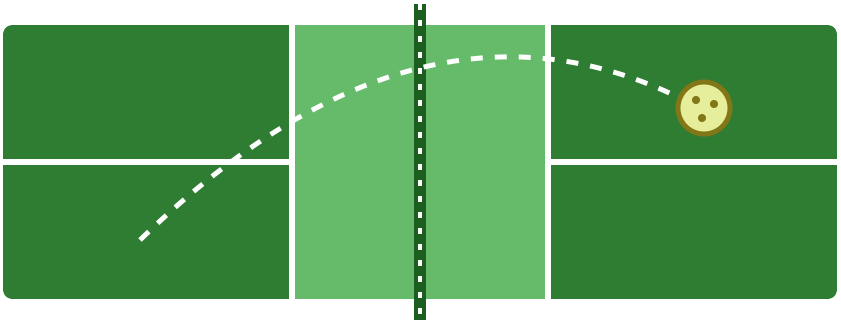
# Your PLUPR, explained

What moves your number, what never does, and how to use it to find a great game.





FINAL

**11–7**

✓ confirmed

## 3 THINGS TO KNOW

✓

### Only confirmed scores count

The other team confirms within an hour, then your numbers move. No confirm, no change.

↻

### Seasons restart. Your overall doesn't.

League standings reset every period. Your overall PLUPR keeps building with every match.

≈

### Close numbers, close games

Compare PLUPRs to pick fair opponents, balanced doubles teams and good practice partners.


What is your overall PLUPR? 2

What makes it move 3

How big a move? 4

Leagues and seasons 5

Tournaments, events and everything else 6

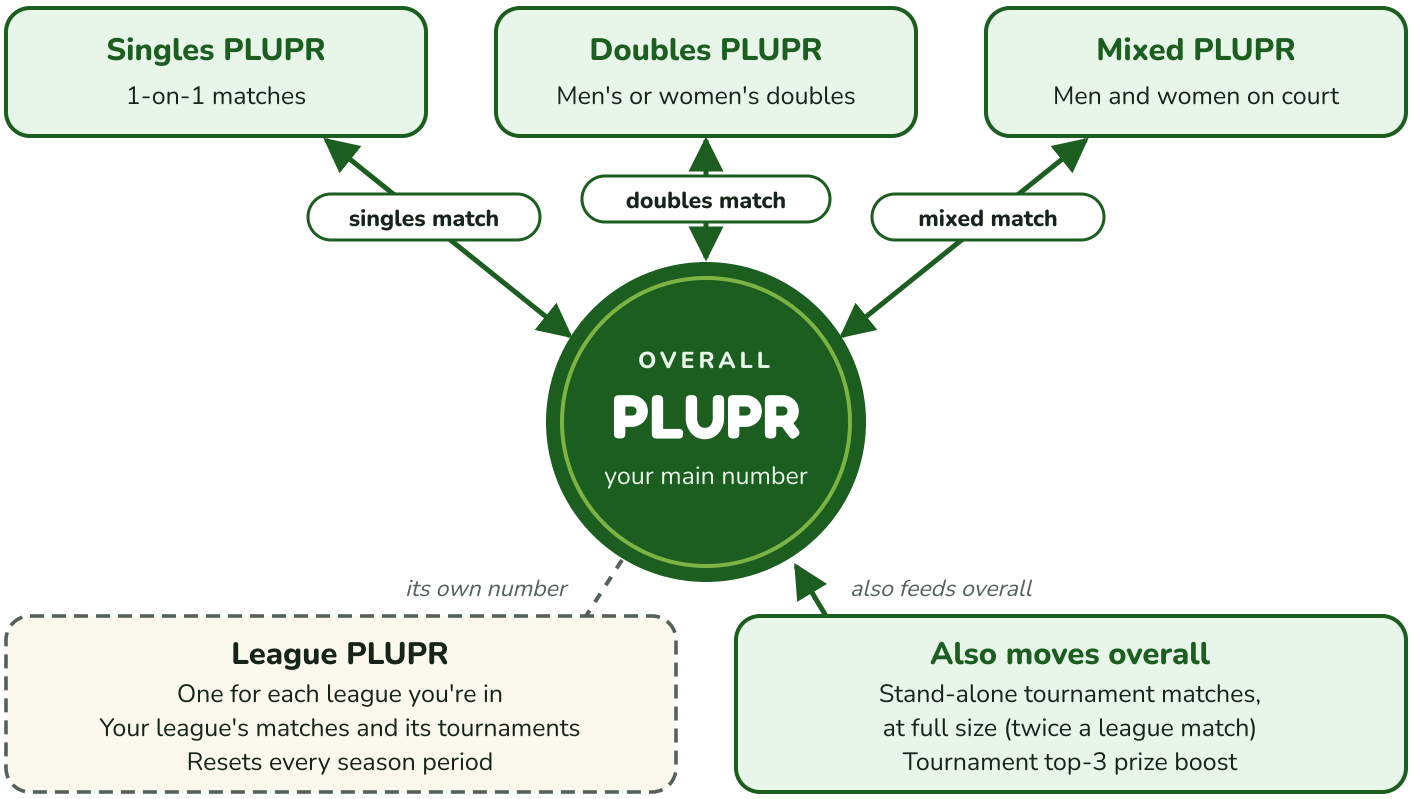
Is this a good match? 7

Quick answers 8

THE BASICS

# 1 What is your overall PLUPR?

PLUPR is Pickleague's skill rating. Your **overall PLUPR** is your main number: the one other players see next to your name in league member and tournament lists. Higher means stronger. Behind it sit a few more specific numbers.




Each two-way arrow is one kind of match. It moves your overall and that one number together.




The scale, with the skill bands the app uses. New players show “Not Rated” until their first rated match.

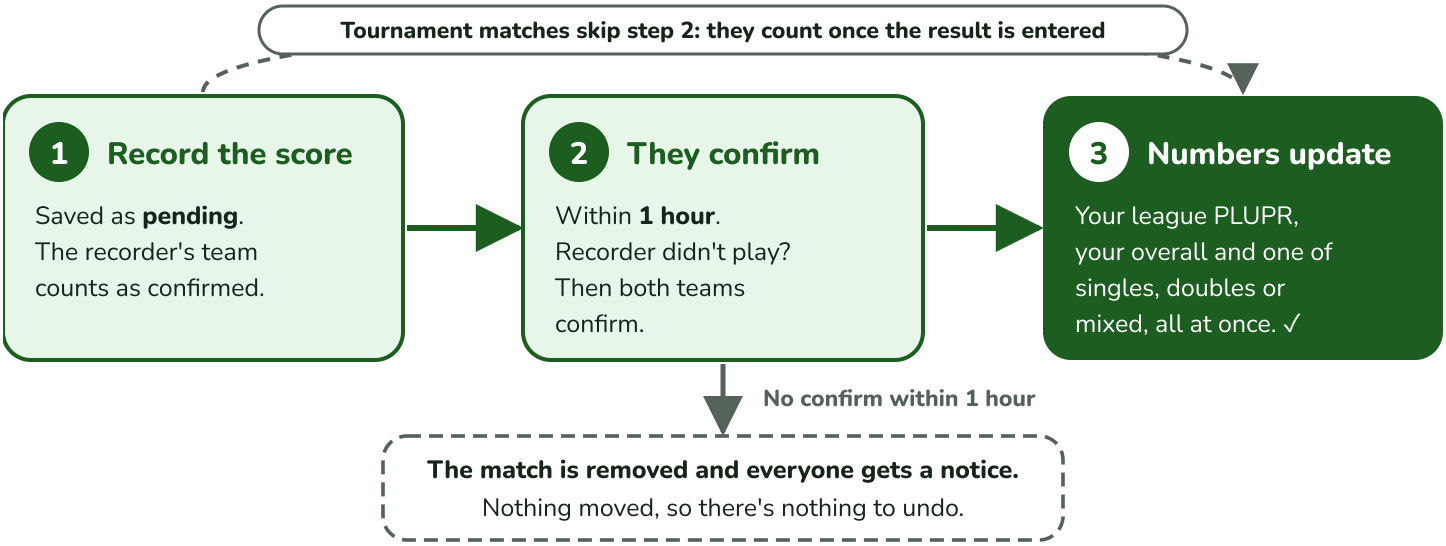
| Match | Overall | Singles / Doubles / Mixed | League PLUPR |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Singles match** | ✓ Half size | ✓ Singles | ✓ Full size |
| **Men's or women's doubles** | ✓ Half size | ✓ Doubles | ✓ Full size |
| **Mixed doubles**<br>a man and a woman on the court | ✓ Half size | ✓ Mixed | ✓ Full size |
| **Tournament match, inside a league** | — No | — No | ✓ Full size |
| **Tournament match, no league** | ✓ Full size | ✓ Matching one | — No |

Every regular match belongs to a league. Recording from Home just asks you to pick one. A league match moves your overall half as far as your league PLUPR. A stand-alone tournament match has no league number, so it moves your overall the full amount.

SCORE RECORDING

# 2 What makes it move

Your numbers move when a score is recorded **and** the other side confirms it. Until then, nothing changes.




## ✗ Never moves PLUPR

- Pending (unconfirmed) scores
- Expired matches
- Scheduled matches (no score yet)
- Drills
- Play sessions & check-ins
- Routines
- Court arrivals
- Pickles & shop
- Badges
- Season prize pools (pickles)

Read left to right. The striped lane lists things that never move PLUPR, however they turn out.

### Check before you confirm

Once a match is confirmed, players can't edit or delete it. Wrong score? There's no reject button: don't confirm, and it's removed after an hour. Then record the right score.

### Doubles needs everyone's gender

Each doubles player needs a gender (“prefer not to say” counts as not set). Set yours in your profile, or the recorder picks one for that match before saving. It decides whether the match counts as doubles or mixed.

### Guests count

Matches with guests are rated like any other match. Their numbers also shape what's expected of you.

### Confirm in one tap

Confirm straight from the push notification, or in Match History, which shows the time left, like “42m left”.

### Tournament matches work differently

No confirm step. Any player in the match, or the organizer, can enter the result. It counts at once, and after that not even the organizer can change it. Check before saving.

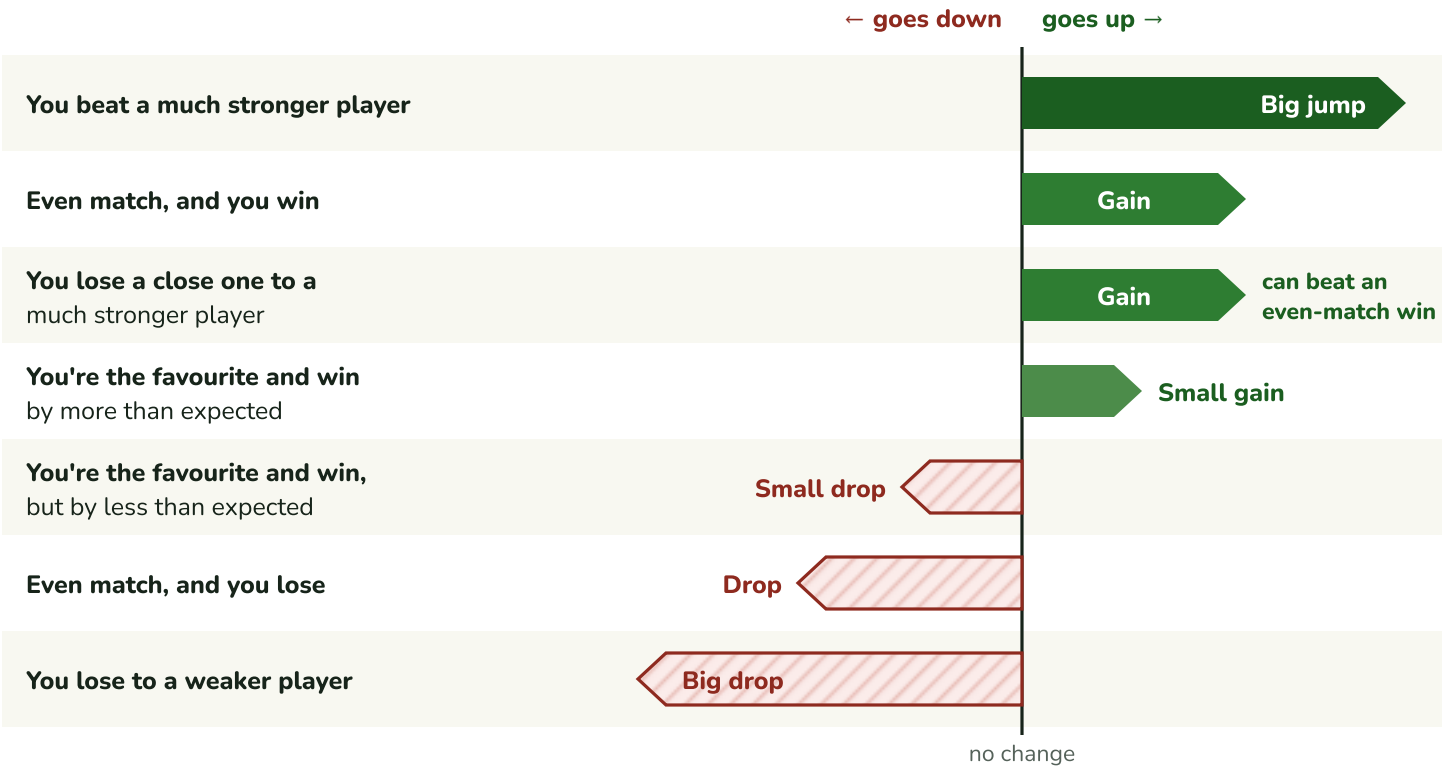
### See the change

Match History shows how much each confirmed match moved your overall PLUPR, like “+0.06”. Your league PLUPR moved twice that. Tournament bracket matches don't show a change.

SIZE OF THE CHANGE

# 3 How big a move?

Every match compares what was expected with what happened. The bigger the surprise, the bigger the move. Winning isn't the whole story: the score counts too.




Arrow length shows roughly how far your number moves. No numbers needed: the direction and size are what matter.

### Who you play

Beat someone stronger and you jump further. Lose to someone weaker and you drop further.

### The score, not just the win

The gap between two players predicts a winning margin. Beat that margin and you go up; fall short and you can go down, even in a win. Multi-game matches add up the points from every game.

### New players in the match

Moves are bigger when the **Team 1 player** slot (not the partner) holds someone with fewer than 15 matches. Everyone in that match moves by that same step.

### Your partner

In doubles, each team is the average of its two players' overall PLUPRs. Partners always get the same change. A strong partner raises what's expected, so a win earns a little less.

### League number vs overall

A league match moves your league PLUPR twice as far as your overall. A stand-alone tournament match has no league number, so it moves your overall the full amount: twice what the same result in a league would. For an even match between regulars, your overall usually moves by just a few hundredths. That's normal: it builds slowly and steadily.

4

LEAGUES

# Leagues and seasons

A season is its own mini-competition with its own standings. Your overall PLUPR runs alongside it and is never reset.

### Stays inside the season

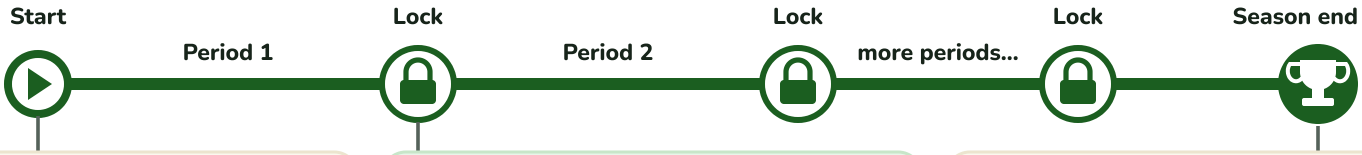
- Each period ranks players by their **league PLUPR**.
- The admin sets the season's **baseline** when creating it, usually 3.50. It's pre-filled from a level in the league name, like “4.5 League”.
- At each lock, league PLUPR goes back to the baseline. The top 5 get a small head start.
- Before the first lock, new members sit at 3.25 and returning members keep last season's finish.
- Your final season rank.

### Keeps going, season after season

- **Overall PLUPR.** Every confirmed match adds to it; league matches count at half size. No period lock or season end ever resets it.
- Your match history.
- Badges and pickles you've earned.

Season prize pools pay **pickles**, never rating.

LEAGUE SEASON · SELF-CONTAINED




### Season starts

The **Live** tab starts everyone at the baseline (usually 3.50).

Play league matches. Live updates as scores are confirmed.

### Every period lock

Locks automatically on its date. Ranks are saved. #1 earns the **Period Champion** badge.

League PLUPR resets to the baseline. Top 5 get a head start: +0.20, +0.15, +0.10, +0.05, +0.02.

### Admin ends the season

Not automatic: an admin taps Complete. Final rank = your **middle** rank across periods.

Crown, Silver, Bronze badges; **Period Sweeper**: #1 every time. Admin pays the pool in pickles.

OVERALL PLUPR · KEEPS FLOWING

every confirmed match counts · seasons never reset it




Your “middle” rank means one bad period won't sink your season.

| Standings tab | What the PLUPR column shows | Wins and losses |
|---|---|---|
| **Live** | An estimate: the baseline plus your Match History changes this period. No head start. | This period only |
| **Locked** | Your official league PLUPR when the period locked | Season to date |
| **Final** | Middle period rank, plus your head start for next season | Season to date |
| **No season running** | Members listed by overall PLUPR | — |

At a lock, your official league PLUPR takes over. It moves twice as far per match as the Live estimate and includes your head start and the league's tournament matches, so numbers, and sometimes ranks, can change. Wins and losses count each game of a multi-game match.

5

FEATURES

# Tournaments, events and everything else

Lots of features *use* PLUPR. Only a few *change* it.

| Feature | Moves overall PLUPR? | Moves league PLUPR? | Own standings? | Pickles? |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **League match**<br>once confirmed | ✓ **Yes**<br>half size | ✓ **Yes**<br>full size | Season | Rewards & badges |
| **Match recorded from Home**<br>you pick a league; a tournament tag doesn't change how it counts | ✓ **Yes**<br>half size | ✓ **Yes**<br>full size | Season | Rewards & badges |
| **Tournament match in a league** | — No | ✓ **Yes** | Tournament | Entry fee, prize pot |
| **Stand-alone tournament match** | ✓ **Yes**<br>full size | — No | Tournament | Entry fee, prize pot |
| **Tournament prize payout**<br>1st, 2nd, 3rd | ✓ **+0.50 / +0.25 / +0.10**<br>once; league tournaments too | — No | — | Prize pot |
| **Period lock & season end** | — No | ↻ **Resets to baseline**<br>top 5 get a head start | Period & final ranks | Prize pool, paid by an admin |
| **Event**<br>voting and scheduling | Only via matches played there | Only via matches | — No | — |
| **Drill** | — No | — No | 1–5 reviews | Yes |
| **Play session, check-in, routine** | — No | — No | — No | Reward pickles |
| **Badges** | — No<br>Top Rated needs 4.00 | — No | — No | 150 per badge |
| **DUPR import** | **Sets your start**<br>before your first match only | — No | — | — |

## Tournaments at a glance

### No confirm step

Any player in the match, or the organizer, can enter the result. It counts at once, and after that not even the organizer can change it. Check before saving.

### Top-3 boost needs a payout

The organizer completes the tournament, then taps **Pay out prizes**, which only shows when there's a pickle pot. The boost goes to your overall, in league tournaments too. In single elimination, both losing semi-finalists count as 3rd.

### Seeding reads PLUPR, never changes it

Organizers seed randomly or by overall PLUPR; doubles teams by partner average. Standings count wins first. PLUPR only breaks late ties.

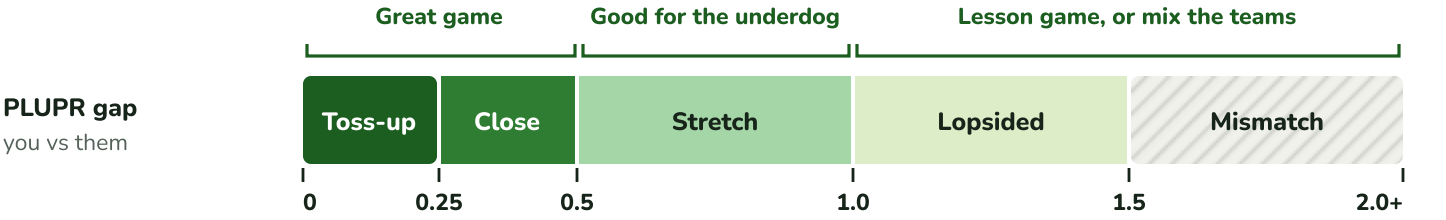
### MLP: every game counts on its own

Men's and women's games count as doubles, the mixed games as mixed, and the Dreambreaker as singles.

FINDING A GAME

# 6 Is this a good match?

The gap between two PLUPRs tells you how close a game will probably be. **IN THE APP** marks what Pickleague does; **OUR TIP** marks friendly advice.




| | even | 0.25 | 0.5 | 1.0 | 1.5 | 2.0+ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Typical game to 11** | even | 11–9 | 11–6 | 11–3 | 11–2 | 11–1 |

Singles: compare the two players. Doubles: compare the two team averages.

### Opponents OUR TIP

- Within 0.25: a coin flip.
- Up to 0.5: still a real match.
- 0.5 to 1.0: worth it for the underdog. You only drop if you lose by more than expected.
- Over 1.5: little at stake either way.

### Practice partners

OUR TIP Stay within about 0.5. To improve, drill with someone 0.25 to 0.5 above you.

IN THE APP Drill Search's **Skill match** sort puts the closest PLUPR first.

### Partners IN THE APP

**Your chemistry together**, on a player's profile, compares your win rate with them against your win rate with other partners. It gives a verdict after 5 doubles matches together.

### ✗ Stack the top two together

4.2 3.8 — avg 4.0

vs

3.4 3.0 — avg 3.2

Gap 0.8: a stretch

### ✓ Strongest with weakest

4.2 3.0 — avg 3.6

vs

3.8 3.4 — avg 3.6

Gap 0.0: a toss-up

### Balancing doubles

IN THE APP Tournament organizers: **Snake-Pair (balanced)** pairs strongest with weakest. MLP's Snake-Draft does the same for teams of 4.

OUR TIP Aim for team averages within 0.25, and keep each player within about 1.0 of the court's average. Opponents aim at the weaker player, and the numbers can't see that.

### Where to compare numbers IN THE APP

- **League Members** shows everyone's PLUPR. Admins: “Suggest” lists players within 1.75 of the average.
- **Players here** at a court: doubles PLUPR (can differ from overall), or a band like “3.5–4.0”.
- **Drill Search:** “+0.16 vs you”. Organizers: invites list players within 1.5 of the field.
- Check-in tags like “3.5+” are just labels, not checked against PLUPR.

7

FAQ

# Quick answers

The questions players ask most.

### Why didn't my PLUPR change?

Usually the match isn't confirmed yet. It also won't move if the match expired or was only scheduled. A scheduled match never counts: after you play, record the score as a new match. Drills, check-ins and pickles never move it.

### What if nobody confirms my match?

After one hour the match is removed and everyone gets a notice. Nothing moved, so there's nothing to undo. Record it again and ask the other team to confirm.

### The score someone entered is wrong. What now?

Don't confirm it. There's no reject button, so it's removed after an hour. Then record the right score. Once a match is confirmed, players can't edit or delete it.

### Does a tournament count?

Yes. Matches in a league tournament count toward that league's PLUPR, not your overall. Stand-alone tournament matches count toward your overall at full size, twice a league match. If the organizer pays out prizes, 1st, 2nd and 3rd get a one-time overall boost (+0.50, +0.25, +0.10), in league tournaments too.

### Does a bad league season lower my overall PLUPR?

Season resets and ranks never touch your overall. The league matches themselves do: each one, won or lost, moves your overall by half as much as your league PLUPR.

### I won. Why did my PLUPR go down?

You were the favourite and won by less than expected. Win by more than the gap predicts and you go up. The flip side: a close loss to a much stronger side can raise you.

### Where do I see my PLUPR?

Your profile doesn't show it right now. Your overall PLUPR appears in a league's Members list, tournament player lists and Drill Search. Match History shows how much each regular match moved your overall. The Locked and Final standings tabs show your league PLUPR; the Live tab shows an estimate.

### Why does it say “Not Rated”?

You haven't played a rated match yet. Everyone starts at 3.25, or at an imported DUPR. Your number appears after your first confirmed match.

### Can I start from my DUPR rating?

Yes, if your confirmed email matches a synced DUPR club roster and you haven't played a match here yet. After that, DUPR is only linked: your PLUPR is earned from matches here. League PLUPR always starts at 3.25.

### Do guests count? What about pickles?

Guests count: matches with guests are rated like any other. Pickles, badges and season prize pools never change PLUPR. The tournament top-3 boost is the one prize that does.

### The 10-second version

**Confirm within the hour** · **Set genders for doubles** · **Check the score before you confirm** · **Seasons reset; overall keeps going** · **Gap under 0.5 = a close game**